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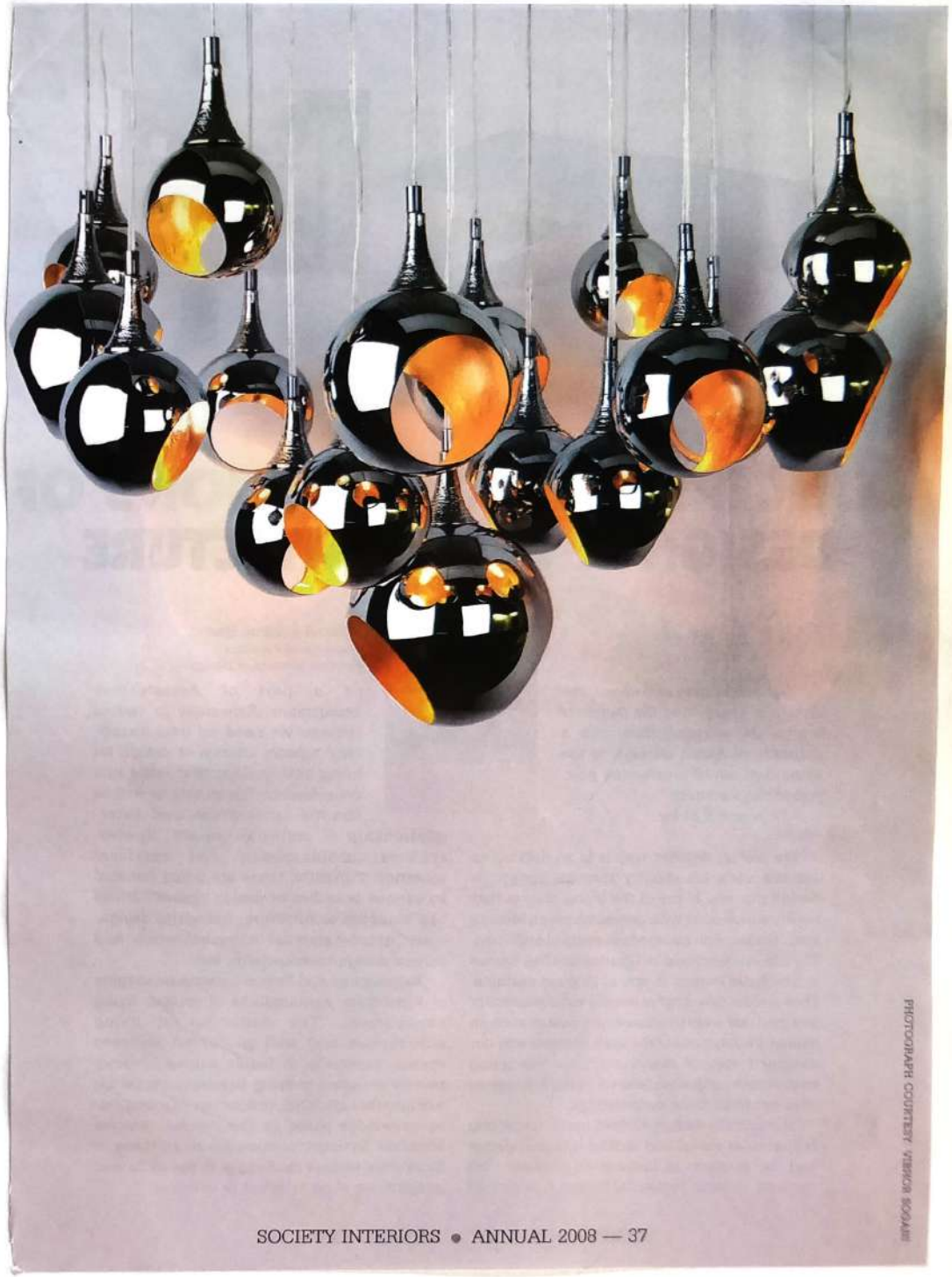
The realm of design is colossal; its outreach unfathomable; its aesthetic appreciation resolutely biased... yet we have, amid innumerable fluctuating parameters, attempted to touch upon various aspects that may exploit this genre... and particularly the more prominent aspects that are major influences on changing trends in this paradox called *Product Design*.

Product design is oft equated with industrial design. Right from creating a tangible three-dimensional object that has a definitive function and successfully combines art, science and technology to leading the product from conception to market, the product designer performs a multifaceted role.

Speaking of idea conceptualization, two schools of thought prevail: the majority concurs with ideation of a product that arises from a need and has a use; where as the other more cerebral aspect is controversially passionate. The product comes first and its application is subsequently generated. This is perhaps the more difficult path. In any case, beginning at the fire-up — from idea generation to screening for pragmatism, the process of new product development to market feasibility studies and commercialization, let us seek a few expert views.

Professor P Rama Krishna Rao, Discipline of Furniture, from the venerated National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad, gives us the educationalist deliberation that defines and regimens Product Design per se...



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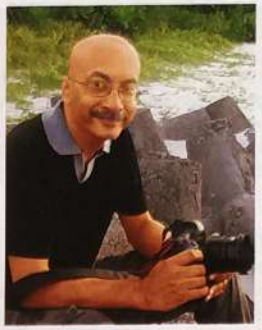
Whilst comprehending the magnitude of the issue of Product Design, and sifting the grain from the chaff, we realized that there is so much talk about our country now being ready to accept design as an identifiable entity. Yet the National Design Policy in its nascent *avatar* seeks to put forth several issues in a clearer perspective before the country can well be on its way to being called a 'design-recognizing' nation. The positive face of the coin depicts some action in this regard but a dalliance still prevails. This uncertainty has to be taken charge of and a vision has to be chiselled out of the existing mayhem, where everyone - from designer to production personnel to the promotion gurus, seem to be coming forth with more inanities than workable solutions.

Several processes – big and not so big, overt and covert — need to be integrated into the system enabling holism of concept and action. The success stories that we have appraised also underline the fact that India is certainly on the anvil of something big – as a complete design movement. In tandem with these thoughts and armed with a host of pertinent, at times politically non-apropos enquiries, Savitha Hira invited a few of our *desi* experts to bludgeon the issue...



Sandeep Mukherjee (SM) is the founder-director of Quetzel Design, which was set up in 2000. The company specializes in providing end-to-end solutions in furniture design.

Alex Davis (AD) is a Product Designer and founder of design studio/store 'Indi Store', New Delhi handling interior, furniture and product design as well as retailing furniture, accessories and lighting.

Reboni Saha (RS) set up Mozaic Design in 2002 with architect Dean D'Cruz in Goa and heads the product design wing, working on diverse projects.

Vibhor Sogani (VS) is the first Indian Product Designer to launch his own Signature Brand of Lifestyle Accessories. In addition to a prolific design repertoire, he debuts a new range of decorative lights this season.

Savitha Hira (SH) is a freelance design writer. Her contribution to the subject of design is as prolific as it is to fine art through her gallery called Pradarshak.

Neil Foley (NF) is an award-winning product designer from Bangalore designing kitchen appliances, consumer durables, fashion accessories, etc.

Mukul Goyal (MG) is the Principal Designer and Director of Designwise India. He attempts to combine the conventional with the contemporary working with a range of materials, techniques, and craftsmen.